
BRIDGEPOINTE

WHERE CRAFT MEETS HOME

Crew Portal

Owner's Guide

A field-to-office system for in-house crew and subcontractors — bilingual, mobile-first, owner-built.

Prepared for the owner · May 2026

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*This guide pairs with the live system at **/admin** (office) and **/portal** (crew). Both share the same database, the same people, and the same source of truth.*

SECTION I

The Business Case

Why this exists

You already run a CRM. That part is not new. What is new is that the crew now logs in too. Marcus, Aisha, Diego, Patrick, and the subs who walk on and off your jobs every week now have their own door into the same system you and Brenda already use. They walk onto a Buckhead repaint, open the portal on their phone, see the job, see the punch list, take five photos, and clock in. By the time they pull out of the driveway that afternoon, the office already has the day's record. Nothing waits until Friday. Nothing lives in a screenshot.

For years the field-to-office handoff has run on text messages, group chats, screenshots forwarded twice, and the end-of-week conversation where Brenda chases down hours and Patrick tries to remember which Brookhaven job was finished Tuesday and which was finished Wednesday. That worked when Bridgepointe was three guys and a truck. It does not scale to ten employees, six to eight active subs, and a project pipeline averaging \$145K a job. The portal puts photos, time, status, and pay communication into one place that follows every job from kickoff to final invoice, in whichever language each crew member prefers. It is not a fancier phone tree. It is the system of record.

The shift you are making is small in technical terms and large in operational terms. The CRM at `/admin` keeps doing what it has always done — that is your view, and Brenda's, and Patrick's. The portal at `/portal` is the new piece. It is a door, sized to a phone, that lets the field push information *in* instead of waiting for the office to pull it *out*. Once that door is open and the crew is using it daily, the office stops being the bottleneck. That is the entire point.

The five problems this solves

1. Photos in one place, not 47 group texts

Right now, before-and-after photos for a master bath remodel in Brookhaven live on Marcus's iPhone, on Aisha's Android, on Diego's cracked screen that he has been meaning to replace since February, and in a WhatsApp thread with three subs that nobody scrolls back through. When a homeowner disputes whether the trim was sanded before the second coat, you have to text three people and hope. When a phone breaks or gets sold, those photos are gone.

The portal stores every photo by project, by phase, with before/during/after tags. Anyone in the office can pull up the full visual history of a job in five seconds. Based on 240 jobs a year at an average \$145K project, even one disputed phase per quarter that gets resolved by pulling up a timestamped photo saves \$2,000 to \$4,000 a year in argued change orders and avoided rework. That is before you count the marketing photos that no longer get lost

when somebody upgrades to a new phone.

2. Crew clocks themselves in

Right now, Brenda spends most of Friday morning chasing timesheets. She texts Marcus. She calls Diego. She squints at a hand-written sheet from a sub that has Tuesday's hours written over Monday's. By the time payroll is reconciled, half the day is gone. Four hours a week, fifty weeks a year, on a \$58,000 base salary at office-overhead loaded rate, that is roughly \$5,500 a year of office time spent on a problem the crew can solve in ten seconds by tapping a button at the start and end of their shift.

The portal lets every in-house employee clock in and out from their phone at the job site. The hours flow straight into the office view. Brenda's job changes from chasing to reviewing and approving — which takes thirty minutes, not four hours. As a bonus, you stop losing money to rounding-up errors. When a hand-written sheet says "got there around 8," that almost never means 8:14. The portal records the actual minute.

3. Subs get clarity on what they owe and what they're owed

Your subcontractors call the office. A lot. "Did you guys pay invoice 0142?" "When does my next payment hit?" "What did we agree on for the Buckhead trim job?" Every one of those calls pulls Brenda or Patrick away from work that actually moves jobs forward. One to two calls a week per active sub, across six to eight subs, runs about an hour of office time a week answering questions the sub could answer himself. At the same loaded office rate, that is roughly \$2,500 a year recovered.

The portal gives each sub a billings dashboard. They log in, they see what is open, what is paid, what is scheduled. They stop calling, or they call only when something is actually wrong, which is what calls should be for.

4. Status from the field, in real time

When Marcus marks the prime coat complete on a Buckhead exterior repaint, the office knows immediately. Patrick does not have to wait for the Friday roundup to find out a phase wrapped on Tuesday. Brenda does not have to discover, three weeks later, that a billable phase was finished on the 14th and never invoiced. That kind of lag is normal in this business and it is not free. Cash that should have been collected on day 30 gets collected on day 38 instead, and you are essentially financing your client's project for an extra week.

On \$1.5M in annual revenue, shaving five to ten days off the average billing cycle saves around \$1,500 a year just in financing cost on the float — and that is a conservative estimate at current short-term rates. The bigger win is psychological. You stop having the conversation that starts with "I thought we billed for that already."

5. Bilingual by default

Roughly half of the trade workforce on Atlanta residential remodels speaks Spanish at home. Forcing a crew member to navigate English-only software adds friction on every interaction. They squint, they guess, they ask the foreman, they sometimes just stop using the tool. Multiply that by every clock-in, every photo upload, every status update, every week, and you have built a tax on your own crew's time.

The portal toggles English and Spanish per user, set once at the profile level. Diego sees Spanish. Patrick sees English. Same data, same job, same workflow. Onboarding a new Spanish-first crew member takes minutes instead of a week of supervised use. The number of "I didn't understand the form" mistakes drops to near zero.

The math, conservatively

Line item	Annual upside
Photo organization (resolved disputes + retained marketing photos)	\$3,000
Bookkeeper time recovered (timesheet chase + sub questions)	\$5,500
Faster billing (5-day cash improvement on \$1.5M revenue)	\$1,500
Subs answering their own billing questions	\$2,500
Reduced rework from early issue flagging (one prevented re-paint)	\$4,000
Marketing content from auto-photographed jobs (social + portfolio)	\$5,000
Total annual upside	~\$21,500

This is conservative. It does not count the harder-to-price wins: fewer awkward conversations with clients about disputed work, less weekend stress on Patrick, faster turnaround on referrals because every job has a photographable result, and the simple fact that crew members who feel like the office sees their work tend to stay longer. Painter and crew turnover in Atlanta residential remodeling runs hot every spring. If the portal is part of why one good lead painter sticks around an extra year, you have just saved a recruiting and onboarding cost that easily clears five thousand dollars on its own.

The other thing the table does not show is leverage. Most of these line items get bigger as Bridgepointe grows. If you go from \$1.5M to \$2M in revenue, the billing-cycle savings grow. If you take on two more subs, the dashboard hours saved grow. The portal does not get more expensive when the company grows. The benefit does.

This pays for itself the first time it prevents one disputed phase from getting re-done.

What it doesn't do

Be clear with yourself and with your managers about the boundaries. The portal is not a replacement for QuickBooks. You still need QuickBooks for taxes, for payroll runs, for the accountant. The portal feeds clean hours and clean billing data into that workflow — it does not replace it.

The portal is also not a scheduling or dispatch tool. Patrick still owns the calendar. The portal will tell you who clocked in on what job, but it is not where you decide who goes where on Tuesday morning. And it is not a direct-message system. Conversation still belongs on the phone, on Slack, on WhatsApp — wherever your team already talks. The portal is for *records*. It is the place you go when somebody asks "what actually happened?" not the place you go to ask the crew a question.

What the portal IS: the single source of truth for who worked where, when, with what photos, with what notes, and what got paid. If it is not in the portal, treat it as if it did not happen. That rule, enforced consistently for ninety days, is what turns the portal from a piece of software into the way Bridgepointe operates.

What success looks like in 90 days

By the end of the first quarter of real use, you should be able to walk into your office on a Friday morning and see all of these:

- 100% of in-house employees — Marcus, Aisha, Diego, Patrick, and the rest — are clocking in via the portal. Paper timesheets are gone.
- Every active project has at least five progress photos uploaded, tagged by phase.
- Subs are checking their billings dashboard before they call the office. The "did you pay invoice 0142?" call is rare, not weekly.
- Brenda's Friday timesheet routine has shrunk from a four-hour chase to a thirty-minute review-and-approve.
- At least one disputed change order — the kind that used to turn into a long phone call with a Brookhaven homeowner — has been resolved cleanly by pulling up the portal's photo timeline.

If you hit those five marks by month three, the portal is doing exactly what it was built to do. If you are not hitting them, the answer is almost never that the system is broken. It is that one of the managers — usually the office manager or the lead foreman — has not been briefed firmly enough on the expectation that this is now how Bridgepointe works. That is the conversation worth having before the next quarter starts.

SECTION II

Admin Operating Manual

This is the manual for the two people who actually drive the portal day to day: you (Mark) and Brenda. It tells you what to click, in what order, and what you'll see on the screen when you get there. Keep it next to the keyboard for the first month. After that, most of this becomes muscle memory.

The portal has two halves. The half you live in is the **admin** side, at `/admin`. The half the crew lives in is the **portal** side, at `/portal`. This manual is about the admin side. The crew side gets its own short guide that you can hand to Marcus or to a new hire on day one.

Getting in

Open your browser and go to `/admin` on your live site (the same domain Brenda uses for invoicing). You'll see a black sign-in card with a gold lock icon, the word **Bridgepointe** in serif type, and two fields: **Username** and **Password**. Type Mark in the username field, type your password in the password field, and click the gold **Sign In** button.

If you ever need to change the password, it lives in one specific file in the codebase: `src/components/admin/admin-auth.tsx`. Whoever maintains the portal for you (or you, if you're handy enough) edits the constant near the top of that file, redeploys, and the new password is live. You don't have a "change password" button inside the portal yet — that's deliberately off until the team is bigger. For now: one password, written down somewhere safe, shared only with you and Brenda.

Once you're signed in, you stay signed in for the rest of the browser session. Closing the tab logs you out. You'll know you're in when the page goes dark and a sidebar appears on the left.

The sidebar is the spine of the whole admin side. Five sections, top to bottom:

- **Dashboard.** Overview of the business and a recent activity log.
- **Operations.** Projects, Estimates, Invoices, Expenses — the money side.
- **People.** Subcontractors, Sub Compliance, Employees, Timesheets — the people who do the work.
- **Crew Portal.** Portal Accounts, Crew Activity, Crew Photos, Announcements — everything that flows back from the field.
- **Reports.** Profitability, Estimate vs Actual, Subcontractor Spend, Labor, Cash Flow.

The current section you're in lights up gold. Below the five sections, in a smaller "Public" group, are quick links to open the live crew portal and the live website in a new tab. Use those when you want to see what the crew is seeing.

***Why this matters:** the sidebar is your map. If Brenda is ever lost in the portal, ninety percent of the time the answer is "scroll up the sidebar and pick the section that fits the question." Need to see Marcus's hours? People → Timesheets. Need to look at yesterday's photos? Crew Portal → Crew Photos. Need to know how the Henderson kitchen is tracking? Operations → Projects.*

Adding a new employee

This is the workflow for hiring someone in-house — a new painter, a new helper, an apprentice. It is the most common admin task in the first 90 days.

1. In the sidebar, click **Employees** (under People). You'll land on the employee directory: a wall of cards, one per person, with their status badge, role, email, phone, and rate.
2. In the top right of the page, click the gold pill button labeled **Add Employee**. The form opens.
3. Fill in **Identity**. First name and last name are required (you'll see a small gold asterisk next to the labels). Add their email — this is the field that turns on the rest of the workflow, so don't skip it. Add phone (use the format (404) 555-0100). Add address if you have it; if you don't, come back later.
4. Fill in **Employment**. Pick a **Role** from the dropdown (Painter is the default — change it for foremen, helpers, apprentices). Pick a **Type** (Full-time, Part-time, Contract, Seasonal). Set the **Hire date** — it's prefilled to today, which is usually right. Fill in either **Hourly rate (\$/hr)** or **Annual salary (\$)** but not both. Brenda's rule of thumb: hourly for everyone except yourself.
5. Fill in **Skills & Certifications**. Both fields are comma-separated lists. So a Marcus profile would have skills like Cabinet refinishing, Spray finishing, Color matching and certifications like OSHA-10, Lead-Safe Renovator (EPA). Use commas, not the Enter key. Notes is a free-text field — put anything Brenda needs to remember about this person there.
6. Important — scroll to the bottom. The last section is titled **Crew Portal Access**. Inside it is a single tile with a checkbox labeled **Create login & PIN now**. It's checked by default and the tile glows gold when an email is filled in. Leave it on. The portal will issue a 6-digit PIN automatically as soon as you save the employee. If you forgot the email up in step 3, the tile turns gray and shows an amber note telling you to add an email above. Scroll up, add the email, and the tile lights back up.
7. Click the gold **Save Employee** button at the bottom right. The button is disabled until both names are filled in, so if it's grayed out, scroll up.
8. The page automatically navigates to that employee's **Portal Access** tab. At the top of the tab you'll see a green-bordered banner with a shield icon and the words **New PIN issued**. Below the words is a single, large 6-digit code in a black box, with the digits widely spaced. Next to it is a **Copy** button. Click **Copy**, paste it into a text message to the employee, and you're done. The banner says "Send this PIN to the user via SMS or in person — it won't be shown again." That is literal. Once you leave this page or click **Dismiss**, the PIN is gone from the screen. The portal does not store it in cleartext anywhere you can read it back later. If you lose it before you send it, you have to issue a new one.

If you skipped the checkbox in step 6 — say you weren't sure about hiring someone yet, so you wanted to create the record without giving them portal access — no problem. Go to **Employees**, click the person's card, then click the **Portal Access** tab. The card on the left will say "No credential on file" and offer a single gold button: **Create Portal Access**. Click it. Same green banner appears, same PIN, same Copy button.

***Why this matters:** the moment a new hire gets their PIN is the moment they go from being a name on a card to being a participant. They can clock in, post photos, see the schedule. If you delay the PIN by even a day, you've taught them that the portal is optional. So treat the PIN handoff like a key handoff — text it before they leave the office on day one.*

Adding a new subcontractor

Subs go through the same shape of form but with a few extra sections because the compliance paperwork matters. You'll do this for any new drywall, flooring, electrical, or HVAC partner.

1. In the sidebar, click **Subcontractors** (under People). You'll see the subcontractor directory.
2. Click the gold **Add Subcontractor** button (top right). The form opens. Notice the four numbered sections — they're labeled **1, 2, 3, 4** in small monospace circles on the left side of each section title.
3. **Section 1: Company Information.** Required: **Company Name, Primary Contact, Email Address, Phone Number.** Optional: **Tax ID / EIN** (in the format **XX-XXXXXXX**) and **Physical Address.** The email is what turns on portal access later, same as with employees.
4. **Section 2: Trade Categories.** A grid of pill buttons: General, Demo / Abatement, Framing, Drywall, Drywall & Paint, Painting, Roofing, Landscaping, Trim & Finish Carpentry, Cabinetry, Flooring, Tile & Stone, Plumbing, Electrical, HVAC, and Cleaning / Disposal. Click every trade this sub can do. Selected pills turn gold and show a dot. You must pick at least one or the Save button stays disabled.
5. **Section 3: Compliance Tracking.** Three checkboxes, stacked: **W-9 Form Collected, Master Subcontractor Agreement (MSA) Signed,** and **Certificate of Insurance (COI).** When you tick COI, the row expands to reveal a required **Policy Expiration Date** field. The note next to the section title says "You can upload the actual files later in the sub profile." — that's true, this section is just a status flag for now. Brenda will hand the actual paper to you and you'll attach it inside the sub's profile under the Documents tab.
6. **Section 4: Crew Portal Access.** Same checkbox as the employee form: **Create login & PIN now,** default on, glows gold when an email is filled in, gray with an amber warning when it isn't. Leave it on for any sub crew you actually expect to log time, post photos, or read announcements. Turn it off for vendors you only invoice (a one-time roofer, for example).
7. Click the gold **Create Subcontractor** button at the bottom right. The button is disabled until you have a company name, a primary contact, and at least one trade selected.
8. You land on the sub's **Portal Access** tab, same green banner, same PIN, same Copy button. Send it to the primary contact — usually the foreman, not the office — because the foreman is the one on site every day.

***Why this matters:** a sub's PIN is what lets their foreman post photos and time entries on your jobs. If you skip giving them one, you'll be back to text-message project management, and you'll never know whether the drywall guys actually showed up Tuesday until you drive to the site. Issuing the PIN at the moment of onboarding is what makes the whole system work.*

What employees and subs do with their PIN

You do not need to walk anyone through this in person, but here's what happens on their end so you can answer questions over the phone:

- They open your live portal URL in their phone browser. That's `bridgepointepainting.com/portal` (or whatever the production URL is — Brenda will know the exact one; this is the URL you copy from the **Share with your team** card on the setup page).
- They sign in with the email on file and the 6-digit PIN you texted them.
- On their first login, the portal forces them to change the PIN. They pick something between 4 and 12 digits — usually a number they'll remember without writing down. After that, the new PIN is what they use forever.

That's it. Three steps, one phone, no app to install, no new email account. You don't see their new PIN — it's hashed the moment they save it, and even you couldn't read it back if you tried.

Granting access later, or resetting a PIN

This is where you'll spend the most time once the team is set up. Resets happen for three reasons: (1) Marcus locked himself out, (2) a sub got a new phone and forgot the PIN, (3) you forgot to give Brenda her PIN and she's been waiting two days.

1. Find the person. For an employee: sidebar → **Employees** → click their card. For a sub: sidebar → **Subcontractors** → click the company.
2. On the detail page, click the **Portal Access** tab (it's one of the tabs near the top of the page, right above the cards).
3. The big card on the left of the page is titled **Portal Access** with a key icon. In the top-right corner of that card is a small status pill — **Active** in green if the credential is on, **Disabled** in gray if it's been turned off.

The card shows you four things at a glance:

- **Email.** The email on file, with a note underneath that says where it came from.
- **Last login.** A real date and time like `4/30/2026, 6:42 AM`, or `Never` if the user has never signed in.
- **Failed attempts.** If non-zero, an amber line appears: `2 failed attempt(s)`. That's your tell that someone is fat-fingering their PIN — usually because they wrote it down wrong.
- **Status toggle and force-change toggle**, both as little tile rows.

Below those, you have three controls:

- **Generate New PIN.** Big gold button with a refresh icon. One click, one new random 6-digit PIN, shown once in the green banner at the top of the card. Use this for "I lost my phone" and "I never wrote it down."
- **Set custom PIN.** A small link below the gold button reading *"Set custom PIN"*. Click it; a text input appears with the placeholder `4-12 digits`. Type a PIN you've agreed on with the person (e.g., the last 4 of their SSN, or a number they already use elsewhere), then click **Save Custom PIN**. The portal validates that it's

between 4 and 12 digits and rejects anything else. Use this when someone has memory issues with random numbers.

- **Force PIN change on next login.** A toggle row that says "User will be prompted on next login" when on, "User can keep current PIN" when off. Default is off after the first login. Turn it on if you suspect a PIN has been shared inappropriately and you want to force a fresh one without immediately disabling the account.

Below the controls is the **Status** toggle: a row reading "User can log in" (when active) or "Login is blocked" (when disabled), with a button on the right. Click the button to flip from one to the other. A disabled account cannot log in — period — but it is not deleted; you can re-enable it later by flipping the toggle the other way.

At the very bottom of the card is a red-bordered button reading **Revoke All Active Sessions**. Click this when someone loses their phone, gets fired, or hands their phone to their cousin. It instantly logs them out of every device. They can still log back in with their PIN if the account is still enabled — so for a true off-boarding, also flip the Status toggle to disabled.

***Why this matters:** the PIN reset workflow is designed so Brenda can do it on the phone in 90 seconds. "Hi Marcus, what's your email? OK, hold on. Click. Click. Click. Your new PIN is 8-1-9-3-4-7. Got it?" That is the whole conversation. If anything in the workflow takes longer than that, something has gone wrong — either you're not on the Portal Access tab, or the email field is blank, or there's an old session you forgot to revoke.*

Bulk-seeding all existing crew (one-time)

Run this once, the first day the portal goes live. Don't run it again after that.

The setup page is at `/portal/setup`. Open that URL in your browser. (It's behind the same admin login as the rest of the admin side, so you may have to sign in if your session has expired.)

You'll see a clean dark page titled **Crew Portal Setup**, with the gold caption **Bridgepointe · Admin** above it. Three numbered cards stack down the page.

1. **Step 1 — Create credentials.** A short paragraph under the title explains: "Generates a portal account for every employee and subcontractor with an email. Default PIN is the last 4 digits of their phone (or 1234 if missing)." Below the paragraph is a single gold button: **Seed default PINs** (with a key icon).
2. Click **Seed default PINs**. The button shows a spinner and the text changes to "Seeding...". After a few seconds, a green-bordered panel appears below it: "Credentials seeded. X created · Y skipped · Z errors." Right below the panel, a table appears titled **Default credentials**, with four columns: **Name**, **Email**, **Default PIN**, and a **Copy** column. The PIN values are shown in gold monospace type.
3. For each row in the table, click the small **Copy** button on the right. It copies a string in the format `email@example.com → 1234`. Paste it into a text message to that person, hit send, and move to the next row. The Copy button briefly shows **Copied** with a green checkmark when it succeeds.
4. **Step 2 — Add sample data (optional).** Below the credentials card is a second numbered card titled **Add sample data (optional)**, with a single button: **Add sample updates and messages**. If you want

the portal to feel populated on first visit — a couple of fake project updates, a couple of fake announcements, a few weeks of demo time entries — click it. If you want a clean portal where the only content is real, skip it. The button is **idempotent**, meaning safe to click more than once: it won't double up the demo data.

5. **Step 3 — Reset all PINs.** Below that is a red-bordered card titled **Reset all PINs. Do not click this casually.** It wipes every existing PIN and forces every user to re-enroll on next login. The only time you click this is if there's been a security incident, like the master credentials list got loose, and you need to nuke everyone's PIN at once. There's a confirmation dialog after the first click — you have to click **Yes, reset all PINs** to actually do it.
6. At the very bottom of the setup page is a card titled **Share with your team** with a code block showing your live portal URL (e.g., <https://bridgepointepainting.com/portal>). A **Copy** button next to it puts that URL on your clipboard. Paste it into a group text or a crew meeting reminder.

Important rule: **only run Step 1 once.** After everyone has logged in once and changed their PIN, never re-seed.

The seed will skip people who already have a credential, but it's a habit you don't want — it's confusing and Brenda will eventually misread "skipped" as "failed." For day-to-day resets, always use the per-person **Generate New PIN** button on the Portal Access tab, not the bulk seed.

***Why this matters:** the one-time seed is what turns "we have a portal" into "the whole crew has a portal." If you do it once, well, on day one, the rest of the manual just works. If you skip it and try to onboard everyone one at a time over a month, half the team will never log in, and the portal will sit empty.*

Sending an announcement

Announcements are how you reach the whole crew at once without sending fifteen texts. Use them for schedule changes, weather holds, payroll cutoff reminders, safety updates, holiday closures, and the occasional "good job last week." Avoid using them for jokes — once the crew thinks announcements are noise, they'll stop reading them.

1. In the sidebar, click **Announcements** (under Crew Portal).
2. On the announcements page, click the gold **Send Announcement** button (top right).
3. The compose page opens. It has four cards stacked top to bottom: **Audience**, **Level**, **Subject**, and **Body**.
4. **Audience** — pick one of four tiles: **Everyone**, **Employees**, **Subcontractors**, or **Individual**. The selected tile glows gold. If you pick **Individual**, two more controls appear below: a row of pill buttons labeled **Employees** and **Subcontractors** (pick which kind of person you're messaging), then a dropdown to pick the actual person. Use **Individual** for things you'd otherwise text, like "Marcus — please bring the Graco sprayer to the Henderson job tomorrow morning."
5. **Level** — pick one of three tiles: **Info** (blue), **Important** (yellow), or **Urgent** (red). This controls how the message looks on the recipient's portal feed. Urgent shows a red banner across the top of their portal home until they tap it.
6. **Subject** — optional, up to 140 characters. A short label like "Schedule update for Tuesday". If you skip it, the announcement still sends; the body becomes the subject.
7. **Body** — required. Plain text, free-form. Write it like a text message, not a memo. The placeholder reads "Write the message here. Plain text. Will appear on every recipient's portal feed."

8. Click the gold **Send announcement** button at the bottom. It disables itself when the body is empty. Within a second of clicking, you're back on the announcements list and your new message is at the top.

When to use each level:

- **Info.** *"New PPE rules go into effect Monday — see the safety card." "Welcome aboard to Carla, our new apprentice." "Office is closed for July 4th."*
- **Important.** *"Payroll cutoff moved from Friday 5pm to Thursday 5pm this week only." "Henderson kitchen pushed to next Wednesday — sub crews please re-plan."*
- **Urgent.** *"Severe weather hold for tomorrow — do not roll trucks until you hear from me." "Stop work on the Olmstead job, the customer changed scope, call me before doing anything else." "Safety incident on the Riverside job — everyone read the photo and ack."*

***Why this matters:** the announcement system is the difference between you running the company by group text — losing track of who said what when — and running it by signal. Treat the levels like real signals. If you label everything Urgent, the red banner stops meaning anything. Brenda's rule: she labels at most one Urgent a month. If you're labeling more than that, the underlying problem isn't the label — it's the schedule.*

Reviewing crew photos

Photos are the truth. They're how you know what really happened on site, and they're what you use to defend invoices when a customer pushes back. There are two ways to look at them: across all projects, or scoped to one project.

All projects view. In the sidebar, click **Crew Photos** (under Crew Portal). The page is a wall of thumbnails, five columns wide on a desktop, with a filter bar at the top. The filters are: **Project** (dropdown of every project), **Tag** (All, Before, During, After, Issue, Other), **Uploader** (All, Employees, Subcontractors), and **From / To** date range. Each thumbnail shows the photo, a tag badge in the top-left corner if the uploader tagged it, the project name in gold underneath, and the uploader's name in small gray type below that. Click any thumbnail to open it full-screen in a lightbox. The lightbox has download and delete controls.

Per-project view. Open the project (sidebar → Projects → click the project), then click the **Photos** tab in the row of tabs near the top of the project page. Same grid, same lightbox, same filters — but everything is scoped to this one job. The tag filter is a row of gold pills along the top: **All**, **Before**, **During**, **After**, **Issue**, **Other**. There's also an **Uploader** dropdown on the right that lets you see only Marcus's photos, only the drywall sub's photos, etc.

When to use this:

- **Before invoicing.** Before Brenda emails an invoice to a customer, she goes to the project's Photos tab and pulls the before/after pair for the bathroom or the kitchen. She drops them into the invoice email. Customers

pay 30% faster when they see the work alongside the bill.

- **For marketing.** Before Brenda updates the website portfolio or posts to Instagram, she filters by tag = **after**, then by project, then she has a curated set of finals to pick from.
- **For dispute resolution.** When a customer says *"the wall wasn't prepped properly"* and you remember Marcus shot a photo of the wall before he sprayed it, you go to that project's Photos tab, filter by Marcus and tag = **before**, find the photo, download it, and email it back. The conversation usually ends there.
- **For management review.** Friday afternoon: you scroll the all-projects view filtered to **Issue** tag for the week. Anything tagged Issue is something a crew member flagged as wrong — bad surface, missing materials, customer changed their mind. Each of those is a phone call you should make before Monday.

***Why this matters:** before this portal existed, your photos lived in five different phones. The crew sometimes texted them to you, sometimes didn't, and the ones they did send you got lost in the message thread. Now every photo is in one place, tagged, dated, attached to a job, and credited to a person. That single change is what turns photos from clutter into evidence.*

Reviewing crew updates and activity

Updates are written notes from the field — different from photos. A photo says "look." An update says "here's what happened, here's what's next, here's what you need to know."

Per-project updates. Open the project, click the **Updates** tab. You'll see a chronological list of every note posted to this job, newest first. Above the list is a row of pill filters: **All**, **Notes**, **Progress**, **Issues**, **Completion**, **Status Changes**. Click a pill to scope the list. Each update card shows the author, the kind of update, the timestamp, and the body. Issues stand out — they're the ones with red accents.

Cross-cutting activity feed. In the sidebar, click **Crew Activity** (under Crew Portal). This is the firehose: every photo upload, every update, every time entry, every login, every PIN change, every announcement — across the whole company, not scoped to one project. The page has a date range (defaults to the last 7 days), an actor / text filter, and a row of entity-type pills you can toggle on and off (project photo, project update, time entry, portal session, portal credential, crew message, photo, update). Click an entity-type pill to include or exclude it.

When to use this:

- **End-of-week review.** Friday afternoon, on the project's Updates tab, filter by **Issues** for the week. Read each one. Any unresolved issue is your homework for Monday.
- **Audit trail.** Question comes up six months later: *who marked the Henderson exterior phase complete on April 14th?* Go to the project's Updates tab, filter by **Completion**, scroll to April 14th, and you have the name and timestamp. Every status change is logged forever.

- **Daily pulse check.** First coffee of the morning: open Crew Activity, last 24 hours, all entity types. Skim. If there's nothing in the feed, the crew didn't post yesterday — call Marcus. If there's a wave of photos and updates, the crew posted, and you can drill in to the ones that matter.

***Why this matters:** the activity feed is what gives you eyes everywhere without driving to every site. Brenda runs payroll off the time entries showing up in the feed. You run management off the issue updates. The crew runs accountability off knowing that every action they take is visible. None of that worked when the operating manual was a stack of texts.*

Approving timesheets

Time entries flow into the portal from two places: the crew taps **Clock In / Clock Out** on their phones (which creates a time entry in real time), or they submit a manual entry for a missed clock-in (which goes into a Pending state, waiting for you).

1. In the sidebar, click **Timesheets** (under People).
2. You'll see a list of time entries. Pending entries have a yellow status badge. Approved entries have a green badge. Rejected entries have a red badge.
3. For each Pending entry, click into it to see the details: who worked, what project, what hours, any notes. You can **Approve**, **Reject**, or edit the hours before approving (e.g., if Marcus wrote 9 hours and you know he was at the Henderson job for 8).
4. Once you approve, those hours feed two things: payroll for that person, and the labor cost on that project's **Estimate vs Actual** report. So an unapproved timesheet doesn't show up in your reports — which is sometimes what you want (when you want to verify before counting it) and sometimes a problem (when you forget to approve and the report looks wrong on Friday).

Brenda's habit: **review timesheets every Friday afternoon, before she runs payroll Saturday morning.** Approve everything that's clearly right. Edit and approve everything that's slightly wrong (and message the person so they know you adjusted it). Reject and message anything that doesn't make sense at all.

***Why this matters:** the moment Brenda approves a week of timesheets, the whole crew can see their pay summary on the portal. They know what they earned. They know it matches what they remember working. And they know it before payday, not after. That's the single biggest morale change a portal like this delivers — and it costs Brenda forty-five minutes a week.*

Disabling a former employee

When someone leaves — you let them go, they quit, they retire, you swapped to a new sub — you do this:

1. Sidebar → **Employees (or Subcontractors)** → click the person.

2. Click the **Portal Access** tab.
3. On the Portal Access card, find the **Status** row with the **Disable** button on the right. Click it. The status pill at the top of the card flips from **Active** (green) to **Disabled** (gray). The status row text changes to *"Login is blocked"*.
4. Below the status row, click the red-bordered **Revoke All Active Sessions** button. This logs them out of every device they're still signed in on — phone, tablet, laptop. If they had the portal open in a browser tab somewhere, that tab is now signed out.
5. (Optional, but recommended.) Go back to the **Overview** tab on that person's profile and update their status to **Terminated**. This removes them from the active count on the dashboard and excludes them from "active payroll" totals.

The record itself is not deleted — and that's intentional. You want their history (time entries, photos, updates) to stay attached to the projects they worked on, for invoicing, audits, and reference. Disabling the credential just turns off the front door. If you re-hire them later, flip the toggle back to **Enable**, and they're in again.

***Why this matters:** off-boarding is the part that companies forget. They hire well, they on-board well, and then a person leaves and three months later that person can still see the customer list on their old phone. The two-click disable plus session revoke closes that door immediately, while leaving the record intact for your books. Five minutes of work, one less liability on your shoulders.*

SECTION III

Crew User Guide

This is what your people see when they pull out their phone on a job site. The portal was built to feel like an app, not a website. Big buttons, simple forms, two languages. If you can read this section, you can teach it in about ten minutes. Hand them the printout if it helps.

"Tap" means a finger on a phone screen. "Click" means a mouse. Ninety percent of crew use is on a phone, so this guide defaults to tap.

First time logging in

Imagine the office just texted Diego his email and a 6-digit PIN. Here is what happens next.

1. He opens the portal URL on his phone — bridgepointepainting.com/portal. The first time, he saves this to his home screen. On iPhone: share button, then "Add to Home Screen." On Android: three-dot menu, then "Add to Home screen." From now on, the portal opens with one tap, like any other app.
2. He sees a dark login card with two fields: email and PIN. He types his work email and the 6-digit PIN the office gave him. Tap **Sign In**.
3. Because it is the first login, the portal stops him before the dashboard and asks him to pick a new PIN. He types the temporary PIN one more time, then a new one (4 to 12 digits — anything memorable), then types it again to confirm. Tap **Save**. From now on, only Diego knows his PIN.
4. If he prefers Spanish, the **EN | ES** toggle at the top of the login screen switches the whole portal — labels, buttons, error messages, headlines — in one tap. The portal remembers his choice on his phone.

If a crew member forgets their PIN, they should not panic and should not try to guess. The office can reset it in under a minute. Same if they get locked out — eight wrong PIN attempts triggers a 15-minute cooldown. Tell them not to share PINs with each other. It is faster to get a reset than to type someone else's PIN by accident.

What the dashboard shows

The dashboard is the first thing Diego sees after login and the page he lands on every time afterward.

At the top, a welcome card with his name and role. If he is clocked in, a green "On Shift" callout sits just below it, showing the time he clocked in and the project name. A **Clock Out** button is right inside that callout — he does not have to navigate anywhere to end his shift.

Under that, a row of stat tiles. For employees: **Active Jobs**, **Hours This Week**, **Open Tasks**, **Unread Messages**. For subs, three tiles — no "hours" tile, since subs bill instead of clocking.

Below the stats, a quick-action grid: **Clock In/Out**, **View Jobs**, **Photos**, **Updates**, **Pay** (or **Billings** for subs), **Messages**. Everything is also reachable from navigation, but most days the crew taps from here.

Then "Today's Jobs" — cards for any project the crew member is working on today. Below that, "Active Jobs" — every project they are currently assigned to. Tap a card to open the job. At the bottom, a recent activity feed shows the last few things that happened on their jobs.

Navigation

On a phone, navigation lives at the bottom: four icons — **Dashboard**, **Jobs**, **Clock** (employees) or **Billings** (subs), and **Profile**. The full menu opens from the top-left hamburger button.

On a desktop or tablet, a sidebar runs down the left with three sections: **Main** (Dashboard, Jobs), **Time** (Clock, Timesheets, Pay for employees — just Billings for subs), and **Personal** (Profile, Documents, Messages). The current page is highlighted in gold. Worth pointing out once: the gold highlight always tells you where you are.

The jobs list

Tap **Jobs** in the bottom nav or sidebar. Filter chips at the top: **All** / **Active** / **Upcoming** / **Completed**. Default is Active.

Each job is a card with project name, address, dates, and a progress bar. For employees with phases on a job, the card shows "X assigned to me" so they know what is theirs versus the rest of the crew's. For subs, the card shows the scope of their assignment and the agreed amount. Tap a card. The job page opens.

Inside a job

A job page has three tabs: **Overview**, **Photos**, **Updates**.

Overview is the basic facts — address, dates, description, and a list of phases (sanding, prime, first coat, second coat, trim, cleanup, whatever the office set up). Each phase shows status (Not Started, In Progress, Completed, Blocked, Skipped) and percent complete.

Photos is a gallery of every photo ever uploaded to this job, plus a button to upload more. Photos are tagged Before / During / After / Issue / Other, and the gallery filters by tag.

Updates is a timeline. Every note, progress update, issue, and completion announcement, in date order, with the author's name.

Marking a phase done

This is the action the office wants the crew doing at the end of every workday. About ten seconds.

From the **Overview** tab, tap any phase row. A modal pops up. At the top, three big quick-action buttons: **Mark Started** (blue), **Mark Blocked** (red), **Mark Completed** (green). For most days that is the entire interaction — tap **Mark Completed**, hit **Save**, the office sees it.

If the situation is in between — say, the second coat is partway done — a slider underneath runs from 0% to 100%. Drag to the right percentage. There is a notes field for context ("two more hours tomorrow morning") and an optional **Flag Issue** button if something is actually wrong on site.

Hit **Save**. The office sees the change immediately. There is no "send" button to remember and no email to compose. Saving is the whole communication.

Tell the crew: end of every workday, open whatever phase you worked on, mark the new percentage, save. Thirty seconds. The office stops calling them, and they stop getting calls.

Uploading photos

Tap the **Photos** tab inside a job, then tap **Upload photos**. The phone's native picker opens — the same one they use for texting a photo. They pick **Take Photo** to use the camera right now, or **Choose Library** to pick existing photos from their camera roll. They can pick multiple at once.

After picking, they see thumbnails of every photo about to upload. Above the thumbnails, two settings: a **tag** for the whole batch (Before / During / After / Issue / Other) and an optional **caption** for the batch. Each individual photo also has its own caption field if one needs more detail.

Tap **Upload N photos**. The portal compresses each photo on the phone before sending, which is critical because most jobsites have lousy signal. A 12 MB iPhone photo gets shrunk to about 400 KB before it leaves the device. The progress bar fills up at the bottom. When it hits 100%, the photos are in the gallery.

*Rule of thumb for the crew: one **before** photo when you start a phase. One or two **during** photos at meaningful milestones — fresh sanding, first coat done, that kind of thing. Two or three **after** photos when the work is signed off. That's it. The office uses these to handle disputes and build the marketing portfolio. Crew member doesn't have to think about it — just tag and shoot.*

Posting an update

From inside a job, tap the **Updates** tab, then the compose box. Type whatever happened. Underneath, four chips: **Note** / **Progress** / **Issue** / **Completion**. Tap the right one. Tap **Post update**. Done.

The good ones are short and concrete:

- "Cabinets dry, ready for second coat tomorrow." (Note)
- "First coat finished on the great room and dining room." (Progress)
- "Hairline crack found on the north wall behind the dresser. Need a call before we paint over it." (Issue)
- "Punch list complete. Walking the homeowner through it at 4." (Completion)

When to post: end of workday, a quick Note. Anything blocking work, an Issue — that one flags in the office immediately. Phase wrapped, a Completion. Updates replace the group text and the late-night call to Patrick. Once the crew gets in the habit, the office stops chasing.

Clocking in (employees only — subs skip this section)

Subcontractors bill against an agreed amount, so they do not clock in or out. Employees, this is the most-used screen in the portal.

Tap **Clock** in the bottom nav. The page is intentionally simple — one huge button in the center. If not on shift, the button is gold and says **Clock In**. If already on shift, the screen shows elapsed time as a giant counter and the button at the bottom says **Clock Out**.

To clock in: pick a project from the dropdown. If the project has phases, an optional second dropdown lets them pick which one. They can type a quick note — also optional. Tap **Clock In**.

The screen flips to live timer mode. They can leave the page, lock their phone, drive across town — the timer keeps running on the server. At the end of the day, tap **Clock Out**, confirm the duration in the popup ("Clock out after 7:15?"), and the portal calculates regular and overtime hours. Overtime kicks in after 8 hours on a single shift.

Hours show up as **Pending** on their timesheet and on the office side. The office reviews and approves them once a week, usually Friday. Once approved, the status flips to **Approved** and the entry is locked.

The portal remembers the last project and phase used, so the next morning the dropdowns are already filled in.

Manual entries

Sometimes a crew member forgets to clock in. Truck breaks down, brain fog, kid woke up sick. Instead of texting Brenda, they go to the **Timesheets** page and tap **Add manual entry**. Pick the date, the project, hours regular plus overtime. Write a short note ("forgot to clock in — was on the Buckhead exterior 7 to 3:30"). Save. The office reviews and either approves it or asks a question. Missed clock-ins become a 30-second form, not a missed paycheck.

My pay (employees) and My billings (subs)

Employees: My pay

Tap **Pay** in the sidebar. Three tabs: **This Week**, **Last Week**, **Year to Date**. Each row is a worked day with regular hours, overtime hours, and gross pay. Status pills show **Pending** (waiting for office approval) or **Approved**.

Read-only. They cannot edit pay records from here. If a number looks wrong, the right move is usually a manual entry on Timesheets rather than arguing about a finalized record.

Subs: My billings

Tap **Billings** in the sidebar or bottom nav. Totals across the top: **Agreed across all projects**, **Billed to date**, **Paid to date**, **Unpaid balance**. Below that, a list of every assignment with scope, project, completion percentage, billed amount, paid amount, and balance.

Subs can see exactly what they're owed and what's coming, without calling the office. Also read-only. To submit a new invoice they still go through the office. The portal is for visibility, not invoicing.

Documents

Tap **Documents** in the sidebar. The page shows every document tied to that crew member.

For employees: W-4, I-9, OSHA cards, driver's license, anything else the office requires. Each row shows document name, upload date, and verification status (Verified / Pending / Expired).

For subs: W-9, Certificate of Insurance, Master Service Agreement. The COI gets a yellow warning thirty days before it expires and a red banner once it actually has — that prompt to renew used to be Patrick's job to remember.

To upload, tap the gold **Upload document** button. The portal asks for the type, issue date, expiry date if applicable, and a URL — Dropbox link, Google Drive share link, or any public-ish file URL. The office gets a notification, verifies, and flips the status.

URL-based on purpose. Crew members don't need to know how to scan or PDF anything from a phone. They photograph the document, upload to their cloud of choice, paste the link, done.

Messages

Tap **Messages**. The office's announcement channel — one-way for now.

Each message has a level. **Info** messages are gray ("Office closed Monday for the holiday"). **Important** messages have a gold border ("Updated handling instructions for the new Sherwin-Williams primer"). **Urgent**

messages are red ("All hands meeting tomorrow 7 AM"). Unread messages have a gold left border.

Tap a message to read it in full. The unread counter on the dashboard ticks down as messages get read. **Mark all read** clears the counter at the end of the week.

This is not chat. It is the modern equivalent of the cork board in the office, except every crew member gets it on their phone. If a crew member needs to actually message Patrick, they still call or text the way they always have.

Language toggle

Bilingual is built into every page, not bolted on. The toggle lives at the bottom of the sidebar on desktop and inside the menu drawer on mobile. **EN | ES**. Tap it. The whole portal switches in one second. Sidebar labels, button text, error messages, page titles, every form field, every status. The choice is remembered on that device.

A Spanish-first crew member can use the entire portal — clock in, upload photos, post updates, change PIN, view pay — without seeing English at all. Same data. Only the labels change.

Profile and changing PIN

Tap **Profile** in the sidebar or the bottom nav.

For employees, the editable fields are: phone, address, emergency contact name, emergency contact phone. Name and email are locked — those changes go through the office. For subs: company contact name, company phone, company email, address.

Below the form, a **Change PIN** card. Tap it. A modal opens with three fields: current PIN, new PIN, confirm new PIN. PIN must be 4 to 12 digits. Tap **Save**. Done. Next login uses the new PIN.

Tell the crew to change their PIN if they ever feel weird about someone seeing them type it. Five seconds, no awkward conversation.

Tips for the field

A few things to mention in person when introducing the portal:

- **Save the URL to the home screen.** One tap to open. Treat it like an app.
- **Bad signal is fine.** Photos compress on the phone before uploading, and the app retries when service comes back. Most jobsite uploads work on one bar.
- **Eight wrong PINs locks the account for 15 minutes.** Wait it out, or call the office for a reset. Faster to ask.

- **Don't share PINs.** Even with crew they trust. The office issues a fresh PIN faster than typing someone else's anyway.
- **Subs: bookmark the Billings page.** Before calling about a payment, check there first. Most questions are already answered.
- **End of every workday: post a Note and mark phase progress.** Two taps. The office stops chasing, and they stop getting Friday-night calls.
- **Issue updates flag in the office instantly.** Use them for anything blocking work, not general grumbling.
- **Photos are forever.** Even if a crew member's phone breaks or gets sold, the portal uploads are safe. That alone is worth showing them.

The portal was built to make their day easier, not harder. The first week feels like a change. The second week, they stop noticing it. By the third, they wonder how anyone managed before.

SECTION IV

Reference & Troubleshooting

This is the maintenance manual. If you (or whoever sits in the office manager seat next) need to know what's where, why something behaves the way it does, or where to look first when a crew member calls confused — this is the section.

It is intentionally dry. The business case lives elsewhere; this is the part you keep open in a tab on the day something breaks.

Map of the portal

Everything the system shows the world is on one of these screens. Two surfaces: the crew portal that crew members log into from their phones, and the admin portal that you and Brenda use from a laptop.

Crew portal (crew sees these):

- `/portal/login` — sign-in screen. Email + 4-digit PIN.
- `/portal/dashboard` — landing page after login. Today's jobs, recent activity, unread messages.
- `/portal/jobs` — list of jobs the user is assigned to.
- `/portal/jobs/{id}` — overview of one project: phases, recent updates, photos, basic budget visibility for leads.
- `/portal/jobs/{id}/photos` — photo gallery for that project.
- `/portal/jobs/{id}/updates` — full updates timeline for that project.
- `/portal/clock` — clock in / clock out (employees only).
- `/portal/timesheets` — weekly timesheet view (employees only).
- `/portal/pay` — pay history for employees, billing history for subs.
- `/portal/profile` — view and edit own profile, change PIN, change language.
- `/portal/documents` — own document list (W-4, I-9, certs, drug-test results, etc.).
- `/portal/messages` — inbox for announcements and direct messages.

Admin portal (you and Brenda see these):

- `/admin` — dashboard with active projects, cash position, exceptions.
- `/admin/portal` — master list of every portal account, last login, status.
- `/admin/portal/activity` — full crew activity feed across all users.
- `/admin/portal/photos` — every photo any crew member has ever uploaded, filterable.

- `/admin/portal/messages` — list of announcements, plus the **Send announcement** button.
 - `/admin/employees/{id}/portal` — manage one employee's portal account (the **Portal Access** tab on the employee record).
 - `/admin/subcontractors/{id}/portal` — same, for one subcontractor.
 - `/admin/projects/{id}/photos` — photos filtered to a single project.
 - `/admin/projects/{id}/updates` — updates timeline for a single project.
 - `/portal/setup` — one-time bulk seed of default PINs, plus optional sample data. Re-runnable safely; only adds missing credentials unless you click **Reset all PINs**.
-

How accounts work

Each crew member has **one underlying record** — either in the `employees` table (W-2 staff) or in `subcontractors` table (1099 partners). That record holds their name, email, phone number, role or trades, hourly rate or default rate, hire date, and so on.

Their **portal credential** is a separate record in the `portal_credentials` table. The credential is linked back to the underlying record by two columns: `user_type` (the literal string 'employee' or 'subcontractor') and `user_id` (which references the corresponding `employees.id` or `subcontractors.id`). One person, two rows: one in their identity table, one in `portal_credentials`.

The credential stores three things plus some bookkeeping:

- The email they sign in with. This must match the email on the underlying employee or subcontractor record. If you change the email on the employee profile, change it on the Portal Access tab too — the system does not auto-sync.
- A hashed PIN. Plaintext PINs are never stored. We never see them, and neither would anyone with database access.
- A handful of state flags: `enabled` (account on or off), `must_change_pin` (forces a password change at next login), `last_login_at` (informational), `failed_attempts` (counts toward lockout), and `locked_until` (set when the lockout kicks in).

PINs are stored as `sha256(salt + pin)` where the salt is a random 16-byte string unique to that user. So two crew members who both pick 1234 end up with completely different stored hashes — and even if the database were to leak, no one could read PINs back out.

Sessions live in the `portal_sessions` table. When a crew member signs in successfully, the server creates a row in that table, generates a random opaque token, sets a secure `httpOnly` cookie carrying that token, and stores `sha256(token)` in the row. Every subsequent request from the phone hits the server, the server reads the cookie, hashes it, and looks up the matching session row to find the user.

The session is **server-side**. The cookie alone is useless — if the row is revoked, the cookie is dead. That's how the **Disable account** and **Revoke sessions** controls instantly kick someone out, even if they have a live phone in their hand.

Sessions expire automatically after **30 days** of inactivity. They can be revoked manually from the Portal Access tab on any employee or subcontractor record.

Security policy at a glance

Policy	Setting
PIN length	4 to 12 digits
PIN storage	sha256(salt + pin), salt unique per user
Failed-attempt logout	8 attempts, then 15 minutes
Session lifetime	30 days from last use
Session cookie	httpOnly, secure (in production), sameSite=lax
PIN reset	Admin generates a new PIN; old PIN cannot be recovered
Account disable	Toggle on Portal Access tab; revokes all live sessions
Email enumeration on login	Generic error ("Email or PIN is incorrect") on both bad email and bad PIN
Server-side credentials	All sensitive operations require the cookie plus a matching session row

A few notes on the table above. The login error is intentionally vague so that someone trying random emails cannot tell whether the email exists. The logout counter resets on a successful login or when an admin generates a new PIN. Sessions are independent per device — signing in on a new phone does not boot the old phone — but disabling the account boots everyone.

What gets written to the activity log

The `activity_log` table is the audit trail for the whole CRM, including the portal. Every state-changing action writes one row: who did it, what they did, when, and a short description.

Things the portal logs:

- Login, logout, failed login attempts, account lockouts.

- Photo upload, photo delete.
- Update post, update delete.
- Phase status changes (when a crew member taps **Mark complete**).
- PIN reset, PIN change, account enable/disable.
- Message send, message delete.
- Time entry submit, edit, approve.
- Session revoke.

The Crew Activity page in the admin portal (`/admin/portal/activity`) reads from this same table, scoped to portal events. You can filter by date range and by actor — start with the date range, narrow to a single user, and the recent picture of what they did is right there.

If you ever wonder whether someone actually performed an action they say they did or did not, this is the table to look at first.

FAQ

1. A crew member can't sign in. What do I do? Check the email on file. Open their employee or subcontractor record, click the **Portal Access** tab, and confirm the email shown there matches what they're typing on their phone. The most common cause of a sign-in failure is a typo or an outdated email. If the email is correct, generate a new PIN and read it to them.

2. Marcus changed phones — can he stay logged in on the new one too? Yes. He can sign in on the new phone without doing anything on the old one. Each device has its own session. If he wants to actively log out of the old phone (say, he sold it), open his Portal Access tab and click **Revoke all sessions**, then have him sign in fresh on the new device.

3. Diego forgot his PIN. Can I see what it is? No. PINs are stored as one-way hashes, so even with full database access no one can read them back. Generate a new PIN from the Portal Access tab, share it with him verbally or by text, and he can change it from his profile after he logs in.

4. A subcontractor texted me a photo — should I upload it for them? You can, from `/admin/projects/{id}/photos`, but it will show as uploaded by you, not the sub. Better: ask them to upload it through their portal. The project photo trail is part of the audit record (and the sub's accountability), so keeping the uploader correct matters more than getting the photo in fast.

5. The portal seems slow on a job site. Is something broken? Probably bad cell signal. Construction sites — especially basements, old houses, and anything behind metal flashing — eat data signals. The photo upload screen is somewhat tolerant of bad connections (it will retry), but most other actions need a working connection. Have them step outside or move closer to the road. If the whole site is bad, they can post updates and clock in once they're back on Wi-Fi.

6. Can two people share one login? No, and please don't let them. Each crew member has their own login. Sharing logins breaks the audit trail (who actually clocked in? who took that photo?) and is a security risk. If a new crew member shows up and needs access today, create their record and seed a credential — it takes ninety seconds.

7. A crew member quit. What's the right shutdown procedure? Open their employee or subcontractor record. Mark the underlying status as Terminated or Inactive. On the **Portal Access** tab, flip the **Enabled** toggle off — this revokes all their live sessions immediately. Their photos, updates, and time entries all stay in place; nothing is deleted. If they later come back, flip the toggle back on.

8. I need to send an urgent weather hold to everyone. What's the fastest path? Go to `/admin/portal/messages`, click **Send announcement**, set audience to **Everyone**, set level to **Urgent**, type a one-line subject ("No work today — flooding") and a short body. Hit send. It lands in everyone's `/portal/messages` inbox the next time their phone refreshes (which happens automatically when they open the app). Read receipts let you see who has actually opened it.

9. Where do photos actually live? Can I download them all? Photos are stored as binary directly inside the Postgres database (in the `image_data` column of `project_photos`), not in a separate file system or cloud bucket. The advantage is one backup covers everything; the trade-off is no cloud-folder browsing. You can download an individual photo by opening the lightbox in any photo gallery view and clicking the download icon. Bulk download is not built yet — if you need everything for a project at once, an engineer has to write a one-off script.

10. What's the difference between "Notes" and "Updates" on a project? Notes are admin-only project comments, written by you or Brenda from the back office, and the crew never sees them. Updates are crew-authored timeline entries — things like "drywall finished in master bed," "found rotted joist behind tub," "homeowner asking about color change." Updates are visible to everyone on the job (including the office). Use notes for back-office observations; updates are the field-to-office reporting channel.

11. Spanish translations — are they perfect? No. They're construction-trade Spanish, reviewed for clarity, but they're not lexicographic. If a crew member tells you a phrase is awkward or wrong, it's an easy fix: open the appropriate dictionary file in `src/lib/portal-i18n/` (one per feature: `auth.ts`, `jobs.ts`, `clock.ts`, `messages.ts`, etc.), edit the `es` value for that key, redeploy. The English side is the source of truth for keys; the Spanish side is the translation.

12. How do I change the password for the admin login? Open `src/components/admin/admin-auth.tsx`, change the password constant, and redeploy. This is intentionally crude — the admin gate is a single shared password right now, not per-user auth. Long term, this should be moved to a real authentication system. For now, change it whenever the team that knows the current one changes.

Troubleshooting cheatsheet

Symptom	First thing to try
Crew member says "I can't log in"	Check the email on file (Portal Access tab, Email row) matches what they're typing.
Banner says "Account locked"	Wait 15 minutes, or hit Generate New PIN to reset the failed-attempt counter.
Photo upload fails repeatedly	The file is over 8 MB after compression — usually a high-res HEIC. Have them switch the iPhone camera setting from "High Efficiency" to "Most Compatible."
Spanish toggle doesn't stick	The browser is in incognito or private mode (localStorage is cleared each session). Use a regular tab.
Activity log feels empty	Check the date-range filter — defaults to last 7 days. Widen it.
Time entry won't save	Total hours equal to zero. Even a quick clock-in / clock-out has to span at least one minute.
Two phases marked complete on the same day on the same project	Both crew members tapped Complete. Use the Updates tab to see who did what when.
Photo shows up but thumbnail is blank	Thumbnail generation failed; the full-size image is fine. Refresh the gallery; if it still doesn't show, re-upload.
Crew member sees jobs they shouldn't	Their role in the employee record might be flagged as a lead or PM. Check <code>role</code> on the employee record; lead-level roles see all projects by design.
Announcement didn't show up for someone	The user hasn't opened the app since you sent it; the inbox loads on app open. Confirm by checking their last login on <code>/admin/portal</code> .

Backup and data exports

The portal data lives in the same Neon Postgres database that powers the rest of the CRM. Whatever backup schedule applies to that database applies here. There is no separate portal data store and no separate file system to back up — photos are inside the same database.

For a one-off export, anyone with database access can run a SQL query against `portal_credentials`, `project_photos`, `project_updates`, `crew_messages`, and so on. The owner does not usually need to do this directly. If you ever want a CSV of, say, every photo with its timestamp and uploader for an insurance claim, an engineer can put that together in a few minutes.

Photos, again, are stored as binary in the database, not in a separate file system. They are included in the same database backup. The trade-off is that the database is a little bigger than it would be otherwise; the upside is that one backup covers everything and there is no second cloud bucket to manage.

When something genuinely breaks

First, look at the Crew Activity feed at `/admin/portal/activity`. Filter to "today" plus the user who reported the problem. You will usually see an error pattern there — a string of failed login attempts, an empty time entry, a deleted update. The activity feed is the cheapest debugging tool available; check it before you reach for anything else.

If you need engineering help, this system was built by Anthropic's Claude as a custom solution. When you write to your engineering contact, document four things in plain English: the symptom (what the crew member or you actually saw), what page it happened on (the URL or the section name), what you expected to happen, and what actually happened instead. Screenshots help. Time-of-day helps too — the activity log is timestamped, so an engineer can correlate. Send all of that and you'll get a real answer back, instead of three rounds of "can you tell me more?"

BRIDGEPOINTE

Where Craft Meets Home

Atlanta, Georgia

Owner's Guide · May 2026